



Fig. 3: It is now possible to map and link a 3D STEP model to the components in OrCAD PCB Editor (Image courtesy: www.orcad.com)

places For loop or While loop around the existing code.

For a particular case structure, it is now possible to replace an input tunnel with the case selector. Earlier, DataPlugins were to be downloaded manually and installed, whereas in the latest version, one can directly

search, install and update DataPlugins.

There have been other enhancements to LabVIEW environment, application builder, Web services and front panel as well.

Innovus. Increasingly, developers are turning to hardware/software

New tools for enabling IC design: A bird's-eye view

Socrates. ARM Socrates DE standardises, configures and integrates IP with ARM IP to create an SoC

Calibre xACT. Parasitic extraction platform that addresses a wide spectrum of analogue and digital extraction needs, including 14nm FinFET, while minimising guesswork and set up efforts for IC designers

Some interesting open source EDA tools

Despite the fact that the big three reign supreme in EDA, given below are some interesting and useful open source EDA tools:

gEDA. This suite consists of various EDA tools that are mainly used for schematic capture, simulation, circuit design, prototyping and production. It was introduced when there was a lack of free EDA tools in the market. It is mostly used for creating professional-quality designs of low- and mid-level complexity.

KiCAD. This tool is used for designing schematics and converting these into PCB layouts with up to 32 copper layers. It includes three main tools; Gerbview is for viewing Gerber files, Eeschema is a schematic editor and Pcbnew is a PCB editor with a 3D viewer. KiCAD runs on Linux, Windows and Apple OS X.

Electric. Electric software can handle many forms of circuit design, including textual languages (such as VHDL and Verilog), schematic capture (digital and analogue) and custom IC layout.

Some other tools. Xcircuit is used for publishing quality circuit schematics, Fritzing can be used for creating layout and manufacturing professionals PCBs and Quite Universal Circuit Simulator (Qucs) provides the ability to create a GUI and perform simulations on the circuit. FreePCB is a Windows platform based tool for creating layouts and exporting designs in Gerber format. Unlike KiCAD, it allows up to 16 layers only. Magic is considered as an easy-to-use tool for circuit layout and is widely used by start-ups, small companies and some universities.

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